Score Board

DirectX 9 AGP cards

Brand	Model	Basic Specifications	Score (Out of 100)		Price (Rs)
		Budget Category	Tier 1	Tier 2	
Gigabyte	Geforce FX 5200	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 3.2 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.4	61.99	NR	4500
MSI	Geforce FX 5200 T-128	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 10.6 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.4	48.52	NR	4500
MSI	Geforce FX 5200 TD-128	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 10.6 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.4	60.10	NR	5000
PNY	Geforce FX 5200	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 6.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.4	55.98	NR	3750
XFX	Geforce FX 5200	64 MB, Memory Bandwidth 6.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.4	64.28	NR	5355
XFX	Geforce FX 5200 Personal cinema	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 6.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.4	57.02	NR	11655
XFX	Geforce FX 5200	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 6.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.4	55.30	NR	4320
XFX	Geforce FX 5200	256 MB, Memory Bandwidth 10.6 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.4	68.23	NR	6210
		Performance Low			
ASUS	Radeon 9550	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 6.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	51.91	NR	5490
ASUS	Geforce FX 5700	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 8.0 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	48.43	NR	8150
Club3D	Radeon 9600XT	256 MB, Memory Bandwidth 9.6 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	59.29	NR	11000
Club3D	Radeon 9600Pro	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 9.6 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	61.79	NR	9000
Gigabyte	Radeon 9550	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 6.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	46.48	NR	4500
Gigabyte	Radeon 9600Pro	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 9.6 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	55.39	NR	14500
Gigabyte	Geforce FX 5700LE	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 6.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	67.78	67.94	12000
Gigabyte	Geforce FX 5700	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 6.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	71.53	70.77	12500
Max force	Radeon 9600XT Bravo	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 9.6 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	54.82	NR	5500
MSI	Geforce FX 5700	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 14.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	52.39	NR	7800
MSI	Radeon 9550SE	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 6.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	42.20	NR	5500
PowerColor	Radeon 9600XT Bravo	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 9.6 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	73.70	64.17	10995
XFX	Geforce 5700Ultra	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 16.0 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	61.92	77.73	13500
XFX	Geforce 5700LE	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 14.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	54.19	NR	6660
XFX	Geforce 5700LE	256 MB, Memory Bandwidth 14.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	57.78	NR	8775
		Performance Mid			
Club3D	Radeon 9800Pro	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 21.8 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 2.0	73.23	66.97	15500
Gainward	Geforce FX 5900XT	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 22.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	73.78	79.40	13750
PowerColor	Radeon 9800Pro	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 21.8 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 2.0	72.55	NR	13475
		Performance High			
ASUS	Radeon X800XT	256 MB, Memory Bandwidth 35.8 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 2.0	67.49	NR	41750
ASUS	Geforce FX 6800	256 MB, Memory Bandwidth 22.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	58.08	NR	32820
Gainward	Geforce FX 6800GT	256 MB, Memory Bandwidth 32 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	73.61	69.88	26995
Gainward	Geforce FX 6800	128 MB, Memory Bandwidth 22.4 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	75.62	58.44	19950
PowerColor	Radeon X800Pro	256 MB, Memory Bandwidth 28.8 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 2.0	70.1	61.95	27995
PowerColor	Radeon X800XT	256 MB, Memory Bandwidth 35.8 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 2.0	69.97	NR	32500
XFX	Geforce FX 6800GT	256 MB, Memory Bandwidth 32 GB/s compatibility DirectX 9/OpenGL 1.5	75.71	60.9	34999

For the entire scoreboard, log on to www.thinkdigit.com, Note: NR = Not Run

In the research time demo, you can check the detail of the textures with utmost ease (which are uncompressed, again) and the light that reflects off them. When the action takes place, you can feel the game lag when all the settings are set to very high.

With this said, let us see how our cards fared. The Powercolor X800 PRO stole the show in 3DMark 2005, but the tests here were done using Pixel and Vertex Shaders 2.0. For the Gainward and the XFX 6800 GTs, it used shader model 3.0, as that was the default selection of the games. Thus, for any future games that will utilise PS and VS 3.0, the X800 will not be a suitable proposition. However, it was not good enough for the Gainward. In our *Doom 3* tests, the X800 PRO suffered, but regained its composure in the other tests. In *Far Cry* and *Half-Life 2*, the Gainward reigned supreme. We also tested *Need For Speed Underground 2* to take image quality shots along with *Doom 3* and *Half-Life 2*. The Gainward GeForce 6800 GT kicked butt, posted extremely good figures across all the tests, and was the ultimate winner in our high-end category.

The Winners Are...

That the competition was tough would be an understatement. It was more neck-to-neck than anything else. The XFX 6800GT performed commendably, but it could never come close to the Gainward in terms of either price or performance, and bowed out with grace. The Gainward 6800GT 256 MB video card is one card that anybody would want to possess. It not only gave terrific frame-rates, but also hit the sweet spot with its price. It is unquestionably the winner of our Performance High Category and gets the Digit Best Buy Gold Award. The X800 PRO gave good results, though they were just not enough for the first spot. Nevertheless, it did make it to second spot, and the PowerColor Radeon X800 PRO gets the Digit Best Buy Silver Award for the high-end AGP category.

Powercolor Radeon X800 Pro

Gainward Geforce FX 6800GT

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